

The Messianic Reversal of the Fall

The following chart illustrates the theological progression from the curses of the Fall in Genesis 3 to their fulfillment and redemption in the promised Messiah, Jesus Christ. It highlights how Christ takes upon Himself the consequences of sin and, through His mission and passion, reverses them and transforms them into blessings. Thus, the ministry of the Messiah is laid out immediately after the promise of the Messiah, and redemption from sin was in view since its beginning.

	Curses	Messianic Fulfillment	Messianic Redemption
Promise of the Messiah	"I will put enmity between you and the woman, and between your offspring and hers; he will strike your head, and you will strike his heel"	"The God of peace will shortly crush Satan under your feet," (Rom. 16:20a)	"The Son of God was revealed for this purpose, to destroy the works of the devil. Those who have been born of God do not sin, because God's seed abides in them; they cannot sin, because they have been born of God," (I Jn. 3:8b-9)
Curses to the Woman	"pangs in childbearing"	"She was pregnant and was crying out in birth pangs, in the agony of giving birth... . And she gave birth to a son, a male child, who is to rule all the nations with a rod of iron," (Rev. 12:2, 5a)	"We know that the whole creation has been groaning in labor pains until now... while we wait for adoption, the redemption of our bodies. For in hope we were saved," (Rom. 8:22, 23b-24a)
	"[your husband] shall rule over you"	"For the husband is the head of the wife just as Christ is the head of the church, the body of which he is the Savior," (Eph. 5:23)	"Husbands, love your wives, just as Christ loved the church and gave himself up for her," (Eph. 5:25)
Curses to the Man	"in toil... all the days of your life"	"Yet it was the will of the Lord to crush him with pain," (Isa. 53:10a)	"Blessed are the dead who from now on die in the Lord... . they will rest from their labors, for their deeds follow them," (Rev. 12:14b)
	"thorns and thistles"	"And the soldiers wove a crown of thorns and put it on his head, and they dressed him in a purple robe," (Jn. 19:2)	"Instead of the thorn shall come up the cypress... and it shall be to the Lord for a memorial, for an everlasting sign that shall not be cut off," (Isa. 55:13ac)

	“sweat of your face”	“In his anguish he prayed more earnestly, and his sweat became like great drops of blood falling down on the ground,” (Lk. 22:44)	“the one who is seated on the throne will shelter them. They will hunger no more, and thirst no more; the sun will not strike them, nor any scorching heat,” (Rev. 7:15b-16)
	“you shall eat bread until you return to the ground”	“I am the living bread that came down from heaven. Whoever eats of this bread will live forever; and the bread that I will give for the life of the world is my flesh,” (Jn. 6:51)	“It is written, ‘One does not live by bread alone, but by every word that comes from the mouth of God,’” (Mt. 4:4, cf. Deut. 8:3)
	“you are dust, and to dust you shall return”	“As was the man of dust, so are those who are of the dust; and as is the man of heaven, so are those who are of heaven,” (I Cor. 15:48)	“Listen, I will tell you a mystery! We will not all die, but we will all be changed, in a moment, in the twinkling of an eye, at the last trumpet. For the trumpet will sound, and the dead will be raised imperishable, and we will be changed,” (I Cor. 15:51-52)